Pupil studio resources & worksheet — Recording an exhibition: three visual moments

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 6 Part 1 · Big question: How do we capture rapid observational sketches, spatial notes, and lighting analyses from curated artworks?

Arrival check

Today our studio is set up as a curated gallery with lit exhibition stations. Why are three focused 6-minute field sketches better than staring at one corner for 30 minutes?

[ ] Capturing three distinct visual moments — Space, Tone, and Surface — gives you complete evidence for your Week 7 review

[ ] Timed 6-minute sketches keep your lines energetic and force you to capture the essential contrast

[ ] Direct annotations written on the spot capture genuine details you would forget later

Starter visual cues

Moment 1 (The curatorial Frame — 6 mins): Sketch how the artwork sits in space, marking the raking light angle and cast shadows.

Moment 2 (The tonal Engine — 6 mins): Squint-test and draw a 5-value tonal thumbnail showing how the focal point

commands the eye.

Moment 3 (The material Close-Up — 6 mins): Look closely on one 5 cm joint or surface transition to record tool marks and patina.

Live annotations: Add specific technical and mood notes around each sketch.

Vote: When making a 6-minute field sketch in front of an exhibited artwork, what should you prioritise?

Studio practice planner

Capture your three live exhibition moments on your clipboard.

Shapes/Focus: Moment 1: Sightline & lamp angle, Moment 2: 5-value tonal engine, Moment 3: 5cm joinery/surface close-up, Dialogue: Juxtaposed pair

Tools/Methods: Mark: Shorthand contour weight, Mark: Squint-test value blocking, Mark: Directional texture hatch, Note: Pointer evidence arrows

Exit ticket

When making a timed field sketch of a textured artwork in an exhibition, how do you record complex surface grain efficiently?

[ ] Render a focused patch of accurate texture in the key zone and pair it with an analytical pointer note

[ ] Leave the texture box blank

[ ] Spend an hour drawing every single millimetre